

Nonprofit and NGO English Participant Workbook

Practice pages for realistic field-specific meetings, pushback, documentation, and role-play preparation

Audience: nonprofit program managers, NGO staff, grant writers, development officers, monitoring and evaluation teams, field coordinators, volunteer managers, and nonprofit executives

Focus: A nonprofit and NGO English curriculum for donor communication, grants, program evaluation, field operations, safeguarding, community partnerships, volunteer management, and mission-versus-budget tradeoffs.

Designed for advanced ESL learners who already use professional English and need industry-specific terminology, realistic meetings, role-play pressure, careful pushback, and polished workplace outputs.

Teaching stance: this is language and workplace-communication training, not legal, medical, financial, safety, or regulatory advice. Instructors should connect every scenario to the learner's current company policies, local rules, and approved procedures.

How to Use This Workbook

For each module, read a workplace scenario and complete a bounded dialogue. Choose one of four options, then use the answer key to see why the selected phrase fits the evidence, risk, owner, and next step.

Module 1. Mission, Theory of Change, and Program Design

Situation

A donor asks how activities create outcomes.

Stakeholder pressure: Use inspirational stories only.

Constraint: Inputs, activities, outputs, outcomes, assumptions, and evidence need alignment.

Terms to use

- mission
- theory of change
- output
- outcome

Guided dialogue completion

Situation

A donor asks how activities create outcomes.

Speaker	Line
Stakeholder	Use inspirational stories only.
ESL learner	I understand the urgency. Before we commit, I need to confirm mission, theory of change, the owner, and the evidence standard.
Stakeholder	What would let us move forward responsibly?
ESL learner	Let's document the risk and prepare a _____ with facts, caveats, owner, and next step.

Choose the missing language

Option	Phrase
A	theory-of-change explanation
B	disclosure
C	grant-fit recommendation
D	evaluation caveat paragraph

Module 2. Grant Proposals and Donor Restrictions

Situation

A funder offers money for work outside the mission.

Stakeholder pressure: Accept it because funding is scarce.

Constraint: Mission fit, restricted funds, capacity, and reporting obligations need review.

Terms to use

- restricted funding
- deliverable
- grant proposal
- mission fit

Guided dialogue completion**Situation**

A funder offers money for work outside the mission.

Speaker	Line
Stakeholder	Accept it because funding is scarce.
ESL learner	I understand the urgency. Before we commit, I need to confirm restricted funding, deliverable, the owner, and the evidence standard.
Stakeholder	What would let us move forward responsibly?
ESL learner	Let's document the risk and prepare a _____ with facts, caveats, owner, and next step.

Choose the missing language

Option	Phrase
A	evaluation caveat paragraph
B	partner recovery plan
C	grant-fit recommendation
D	theory-of-change explanation

Module 3. Monitoring, Evaluation, and Learning**Situation**

A report shows improved participation but unclear outcomes.

Stakeholder pressure: Call the program successful.

Constraint: Indicators, baseline, attribution, qualitative evidence, and limitations matter.

Terms to use

- indicator
- baseline
- attribution

- learning agenda

Guided dialogue completion

Situation

A report shows improved participation but unclear outcomes.

Speaker	Line
Stakeholder	Call the program successful.
ESL learner	I understand the urgency. Before we commit, I need to confirm indicator, baseline, the owner, and the evidence standard.
Stakeholder	What would let us move forward responsibly?
ESL learner	Let's document the risk and prepare a _____ with facts, caveats, owner, and next step.

Choose the missing language

Option	Phrase
A	disclosure
B	evaluation caveat paragraph
C	approval
D	control

Module 4. Field Operations and Partner Coordination

Situation

A local partner cannot deliver services on the agreed timeline.

Stakeholder pressure: Pressure the partner publicly.

Constraint: Local constraints, safety, community trust, budget, and contingency planning matter.

Terms to use

- implementing partner
- field visit
- contingency
- community trust

Guided dialogue completion

Situation

A local partner cannot deliver services on the agreed timeline.

Speaker	Line
Stakeholder	Pressure the partner publicly.
ESL learner	I understand the urgency. Before we commit, I need to confirm implementing partner, field visit, the owner, and the evidence standard.

Speaker	Line
Stakeholder	What would let us move forward responsibly?
ESL learner	Let's document the risk and prepare a _____ with facts, caveats, owner, and next step.

Choose the missing language

Option	Phrase
A	risk
B	owner
C	partner recovery plan
D	evidence

Module 5. Safeguarding and Incident Reporting

Situation

A volunteer reports possible misconduct by a staff member.

Stakeholder pressure: Ask the staff member informally.

Constraint: Safeguarding policy, confidentiality, survivor-centered response, and investigation process apply.

Terms to use

- safeguarding
- confidentiality
- survivor-centered
- incident report

Guided dialogue completion

Situation

A volunteer reports possible misconduct by a staff member.

Speaker	Line
Stakeholder	Ask the staff member informally.
ESL learner	I understand the urgency. Before we commit, I need to confirm safeguarding, confidentiality, the owner, and the evidence standard.
Stakeholder	What would let us move forward responsibly?
ESL learner	Let's document the risk and prepare a _____ with facts, caveats, owner, and next step.

Choose the missing language

Option	Phrase
A	theory-of-change explanation
B	grant-fit recommendation
C	evaluation caveat paragraph

Option	Phrase
D	safeguarding intake note

Module 6. Volunteer Management and Training

Situation

Volunteers want to perform tasks beyond their training.

Stakeholder pressure: Let them help wherever needed.

Constraint: Role scope, training, supervision, risk, and client dignity matter.

Terms to use

- volunteer role
- training
- supervision
- duty of care

Guided dialogue completion

Situation

Volunteers want to perform tasks beyond their training.

Speaker	Line
Stakeholder	Let them help wherever needed.
ESL learner	I understand the urgency. Before we commit, I need to confirm volunteer role, training, the owner, and the evidence standard.
Stakeholder	What would let us move forward responsibly?
ESL learner	Let's document the risk and prepare a _____ with facts, caveats, owner, and next step.

Choose the missing language

Option	Phrase
A	timeline
B	assumption
C	mitigation
D	volunteer boundary script

Module 7. Advocacy, Public Messaging, and Neutrality

Situation

A campaign team wants to use a dramatic statistic.

Stakeholder pressure: Use it because it gets attention.

Constraint: Source, context, dignity, legal status, and organizational position need review.

Terms to use

- advocacy
- campaign
- dignity
- source

Guided dialogue completion**Situation**

A campaign team wants to use a dramatic statistic.

Speaker	Line
Stakeholder	Use it because it gets attention.
ESL learner	I understand the urgency. Before we commit, I need to confirm advocacy, campaign, the owner, and the evidence standard.
Stakeholder	What would let us move forward responsibly?
ESL learner	Let's document the risk and prepare a _____ with facts, caveats, owner, and next step.

Choose the missing language

Option	Phrase
A	advocacy message review
B	approval
C	control
D	disclosure

Module 8. Board Reporting and Sustainability**Situation**

Cash runway is tightening while demand rises.

Stakeholder pressure: Ask the board for emergency funds without options.

Constraint: Scenario planning, reserves, restricted funds, staffing, and mission impact need clarity.

Terms to use

- board governance
- cash runway
- reserve
- scenario

Guided dialogue completion**Situation**

Cash runway is tightening while demand rises.

Speaker	Line
Stakeholder	Ask the board for emergency funds without options.
ESL learner	I understand the urgency. Before we commit, I need to confirm board governance, cash runway, the owner, and the evidence standard.
Stakeholder	What would let us move forward responsibly?
ESL learner	Let's document the risk and prepare a _____ with facts, caveats, owner, and next step.

Choose the missing language

Option	Phrase
A	risk
B	owner
C	board sustainability update
D	evidence

Answer Key and Rationale

Check each answer after completing the dialogue. The rationale shows why the correct phrase is the strongest fit for the real workplace situation.

Mission, Theory of Change, and Program Design

Correct answer	Why it fits
A. theory-of-change explanation	A theory-of-change explanation is the bounded workplace output that captures the evidence, owner, and next action for this situation.

Grant Proposals and Donor Restrictions

Correct answer	Why it fits
C. grant-fit recommendation	A grant-fit recommendation is the bounded workplace output that captures the evidence, owner, and next action for this situation.

Monitoring, Evaluation, and Learning

Correct answer	Why it fits
B. evaluation caveat paragraph	A evaluation caveat paragraph is the bounded workplace output that captures the evidence, owner, and next action for this situation.

Field Operations and Partner Coordination

Correct answer	Why it fits
C. partner recovery plan	A partner recovery plan is the bounded workplace output that captures the evidence, owner, and next action for this situation.

Safeguarding and Incident Reporting

Correct answer	Why it fits
D. safeguarding intake note	A safeguarding intake note is the bounded workplace output that captures the evidence, owner, and next action for this situation.

Volunteer Management and Training

Correct answer	Why it fits
D. volunteer boundary script	A volunteer boundary script is the bounded workplace output that captures the evidence, owner, and next action for this situation.

Advocacy, Public Messaging, and Neutrality

Correct answer	Why it fits
A. advocacy message review	A advocacy message review is the bounded workplace output that captures the evidence, owner, and next action for this situation.

Board Reporting and Sustainability

Correct answer	Why it fits
C. board sustainability update	A board sustainability update is the bounded workplace output that captures the evidence, owner, and next action for this situation.